

COMPARISON OF PROJECT LIFE CYCLES

Feature	Predictive (Waterfall)	Iterative & Incremental	Adaptive (Agile/Change-driven)
Planning	Done fully at the start	Planned for each cycle/iteration	Planned in short cycles (2–4 weeks)
Flexibility	Very low – hard to change once started	Medium – changes possible between iterations	High – designed to handle frequent changes
Delivery	Final product delivered at the end	Product delivered in usable parts (increments)	Product delivered in small frequent releases
Feedback	Taken mostly after project completion	Taken between iterations	Taken continuously (every cycle)
Risk Handling	High risk (issues found late)	Medium risk (improvements between builds)	Low risk (constant feedback & improvements)
Best for	Construction, manufacturing, projects with fixed scope	Medium/large projects with evolving scope	Software, startups, fast-changing environments
Example	Building a bridge (no scope for change later)	Developing a mobile app with new features added step by step	E-commerce site, updated every 2 weeks with customer feedback